



## Gadgets for you

If you're still in your 20's, take a look at this list of gadgets every 20 something worth his/her salt should own. [http://dgit.in/20\\_OrBust](http://dgit.in/20_OrBust)



## Endaga CCN1

If cell signal drops are common in your area, this new device is the solution. It makes dead zones alive. [http://dgit.in/Endaga\\_1](http://dgit.in/Endaga_1)

DIY



controller casing which has the PCB (Printed Circuit Board) exposed along with the vibration motors on a flat surface. If you're working on a wired controller, make sure that you don't jerk or pull on the controllers power cable while doing so. Now, you'll notice that there are two vibration motors connected to the PCB on both sides, the left and the right. In order to disconnect and remove these vibration motors, you'll have to hold down the PCB firmly with one hand and unplug or disconnect the vibration motors' cables from it. After disconnecting the cables, you can lift both the motors out of the front case and keep them away.

## Removing PCB and buttons

Grip the PCB from the headphone jack area and the top power cable area and lift it. Doing this would remove it from the front casing. Set the PCB aside along with its connected power cable and



move on to the buttons. You'll notice that there are two distinct rubber pads above the buttons. These pads are the ones that lie in between the PCB and the plastic buttons that we press while playing. Remove these rubber pads and set them aside as well. Now you'll be greeted by the backside of the buttons. Lift and

remove all of these buttons and set them aside. Note that the centre Xbox button has two parts - the button and a plastic ring around it; Remove both the pieces. To get everything out of the way for thorough cleaning, remove the LB and RB shoulder button plastic arch by lifting as well. You should also remove the analog sticks by gently pulling them from their places on the PCB. Doing so would give you enough space to clean the PCB properly.

## Cleaning

If your controller is fairly old and you've used it a lot or even kept it sitting out anywhere, you'll see that all the parts inside the controller are covered in dust while the places around the buttons and the rubber pads are covered in gunk. Dust and gunk are the main reasons why your precious controller isn't working like it's supposed to and you'll need to wipe clean all the parts to fix it. Start by cleaning the plastic casings first using damp tissues or a soft cloth. We used the Antec Advanced cleaning fluid to spray on the plastic casings and tissues to wipe and clean them. You can use rubbing alcohol or water as well, but use water only for the plastic parts and keep it away from the PCB or other parts like the vibration motors. If you have a can of compressed air, using it to clean the PCB works really well but if



don't have it, then take tissues to wipe off the dust on the PCB. If your analog sticks are unresponsive at times, or they stick to one side while playing and not get back to their default centre position, you should check for dust inside the analog switches. Use an ear bud dabbed in rubbing alcohol to reach inside the

analog switch and clean it. Keep rotating the analog stick and shake the PCB a little bit to remove any dust that may have settled inside the switch. Move on to cleaning the rubber pads and the buttons next. You can use a damp soft cloth or tissues for the same as well. The main area you should focus on while cleaning the buttons is around and below them where they touch the rubber pads as these parts are mostly covered in gunk.

## Cleaning battery terminals

If you've not used your wireless Xbox 360 controller for a long time and forgot to remove its batteries all this while, chances are that you'll find the batteries leaking and corroding the terminals. If that is indeed the case then you should clean the terminals and dispose off the batteries safely. Use a small amount of baking soda, add water to it to make a paste and then using a cloth and your hands, apply this paste to the battery terminal springs that are soldered on the PCB. Do it carefully so that you don't damage the pins or the PCB while doing so. You'll see the paste reacting with the corrosion on the terminals. Use a tissue to gently scrape off the paste after a couple of minutes of applying it to the terminals. Your battery terminals should now be free of corrosion.

## Grips for Analog sticks

It's possible for the grips on your controller's analog sticks to become worn out or broken in places over time. You can head over to [ebay.in](http://ebay.in) to buy rubber grips for the analog sticks which are available in different colours for as low as ₹100 as seen here: <http://goo.gl/rdMTJA>. If the analog sticks themselves are broken, you can buy them too but they'll be available upwards of ₹150 a pop.

After you've cleaned all the parts of the controller, go in the reverse order that you did above for opening it and you'll be able to assemble it back again. Just make sure that the buttons are at their right place and aligned with the rubber pads before you shut the controller casing and screw it back on. Now try out your renewed controller and play on. 